



STRATHMORE UNIVERSITY
FACULTY OF COMMERCE/FACULTY OF INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY
Bachelor of Commerce/Bachelor of Business Information Technology

END OF SEMESTER EXAMINATION

HED 2101: PRINCIPLES OF ETHICS (EVENING COURSE)

DATE: 17th April 2009

TIME: 2 Hours

Answer questions 1, 2, 3 and any three others (Total 70 marks)

Question 1 Definitions (10 points): Give short but complete definitions of:

Happiness; Natural Law; Moral Evil; Indirect Effect; Metaethics.

Question 2 (15 points): Answer the questions using this text.

“Everything is ontologically good; everything is not morally good. Moral good is not a transcendental; it signifies a certain particular analogue of ontological good; it signifies what is good in a certain special order: the order of the fulfilment of human beings, taking into account how they make use of their freedom and pursue their destiny. It is the good — an ontological good — in the particular line or order of mankind, of human nature and human existence; it relates to what man, as a free agent, is made to be.”
From Jaques Maritain, “Introduction to the Basic Problems of Moral Philosophy”, Magi Books, USA, 1990, pg 27-35.

- a) **Explain why moral good is not transcendental good?**
- b) **What does the author mean when he says that the moral good is related to the order of the fulfillment of the human beings?**
- c) **Should the moral good be related with human freedom?**

Question 3 (15 points): Explain and give examples of what virtue is and describe the four cardinal virtues.

Question 4 (10 points): Explain the difference between freedom from and freedom for, its obstacles at each level based on the triadic structure of the person using your own examples, and the moral implications at each level.

Question 5 (10 points): Explain why the formation of the personal conscience is necessary and the steps of its development.

Question 6 (10 points): Explain how the analysis of the moral act requires knowing the moral activity (object) the end and the circumstances.

Question 7 (10 points): Explain and give examples of the three steps of the voluntary act (intention, election and execution) and how they are informed by the intelligence corresponding acts.

Question 8 (10 points): Explain the virtue of prudence and the steps needed to make good decisions.
